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famous Harvard dropouts



Mark Zuckerberg dropped out of Harvard University in 2004 to focus entirely on managing and expanding Facebook, which was growing at a pace that made balancing schoolwork impossible. © CBS News +1

Initially, Zuckerberg and his co-founders only planned to take a temporary leave of absence over the summer to work from Palo Alto, California. However, after securing their first major investments and watching the platform explode across global universities, they decided to stay in Silicon Valley permanently. © CBS News +2

Other Famous Harvard Dropouts

Harvard has famously produced several ultra-successful dropouts who left the institution to pursue career breakthroughs: [↗](#)



Bill Gates: Left during his sophomore year in 1975 to co-found Microsoft with Paul Allen after realizing the personal computing revolution was taking off. The Times of India



Matt Damon: Left in 1992 with only a few credits remaining to take a lead role in the film *Geronimo: An American Legend* and to focus heavily on his acting career. Ivy Coach +3



Dustin Moskovitz: Zuckerberg's Harvard roommate who

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his money partying with vaudeville troupes.



Bom Kim: The billionaire entrepreneur dropped out of Harvard's MBA graduate program in 2009 to return to South Korea, where he founded the massive e-commerce giant Coupang. InsideHook



James Park: Left during his junior year while studying computer science and later went on to co-found the wearable fitness brand Fitbit. Ivy Coach +1



Gabe Newell: Dropped out in 1983 to take a job at Microsoft, eventually leaving later to co-found the legendary video game company Valve.

If you're interested, I can share **what these dropouts said** when they finally returned to Harvard or provide details on **how Harvard handles students who want to pause their studies**. Which would you like to explore?



11 sites

50 super successful college dropouts - CBS News

Mar 18, 2021 — Dustin Moskovitz dropped out of Harvard along with roommate



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Mark Zuckerberg and Mark Zuckerberg are the most well-known names on the list, but they're not alone — and the fact that they share Har...



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